

Google Summer of Code (GSoC) Preparation Guide

What is GSoC?

Google Summer of Code (GSoC) is a global program by Google that offers contributors the opportunity to work on open-source projects with mentorship and stipends. It helps new developers gain real-world experience while supporting open-source organizations. **Goals:** - Encourage new contributors to join open source. - Provide mentorship and experience. - Connect developers with top organizations. **Eligibility:** - 18+ years old - Basic programming knowledge - Able to communicate online **Timeline (Typical):** 1. Jan–Feb: Organization applications 2. March: Organizations announced 3. April: Application period 4. May–August: Coding phase 5. Sept: Final evaluations **Step-by-Step GSoC Preparation**

1. Understand the Program: Learn how GSoC works and visit the official site:

<https://summerofcode.withgoogle.com> **2. Pick Your Domain:** Choose your favorite area: Web Dev,

ML/AI, App Dev, etc. Then, shortlist organizations in that domain. **3. Learn the Tech Stack:** -

Master Git & GitHub - Learn the language/framework used by your target org - Practice version

control commands **4. Start Contributing Early:** Contribute months before applications open. Solve “good first issues,” make pull requests, and join community chats (Discord/Slack). **5. Write a**

Strong Proposal: Your proposal should include: - Introduction & skills - Project idea &

understanding - Implementation plan - Week-by-week timeline - Past contributions **6. Build Your**

Portfolio: Showcase GitHub projects, blogs, and open-source activity to strengthen your

application. **7. Stay Consistent:** Active participation and steady contributions matter more than

expertise. **Rewards:** - Stipend from Google - Certificate - Mentorship from global experts - Career

boost and networking **Pro Tips:** - Start preparing 5–6 months before - Be polite and professional in

communication - Focus on one organization deeply instead of many - Learn to write clean,

documented code